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VENTURE CAPITAL

Here's what the SEC has been up to in 2025

By [Michael Bodley](#)

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U.S. President Donald Trump, left, with Securities and Exchange Commission Chairman Paul Atkins during Atkins' swearing-in ceremony on April 22, 2025.

| Featured image by Chip Somodevilla/Getty Images

Half a year into President Donald Trump's second term, the new administration's **regulatory priorities over private markets** are taking shape.

Venture capital and private equity firms say the Securities and Exchange Commission's deregulatory posture has accelerated since chair Paul Atkins took his seat in April. Atkins, a former SEC commissioner under President George W. Bush, has emphasized opening up retail access to the private markets as a priority.

Here are the key moves by the SEC in the last six months:

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President Trump's SEC tracker: The 2025 regulations GPs need to know

Uyeda named acting SEC chair

January 21, 2025

Mark Uyeda, an SEC commissioner since 2022, stepped in as acting chair, pending nominee Paul Atkin's appointment. Uyeda emphasized the need for the regulator to reduce compliance costs borne by private funds—while underscoring the priority of protecting retail investors.

Crypto Task Force takes shape

January 21, 2025

The SEC tapped Commissioner Hester Peirce to head a new crypto oversight division. The pro-crypto Peirce solicited input from crypto VCs and startups, working to establish SEC standards for digital assets. The industry has long derided the fact that the regulator has applied traditional finance rules to crypto.

Trump orders White House signoff on SEC rules

February 18, 2025

President Trump in an executive order mandated that all federal agencies, including the SEC, submit to the White House all draft regulations for "review." It marked one of Trump's steps to consolidate financial regulation through the executive branch, and it was designed to slow or stop new regulations.

Cyber and Emerging Technologies Unit unveiled

February 20, 2025

Building on its Crypto Task Force, the SEC rolled out a new unit designed to protect retail investors: the Cyber and Emerging Technologies Unit (CETU). It's designed to crack down on hackers, including AI-powered bad actors targeting retail investors. And it is on the lookout for startup cybersecurity vulnerabilities.

SEC drops its Coinbase lawsuit

February 27, 2025

The SEC moved to dismiss its yearslong litigation against Coinbase, in which it accused the crypto exchange of facilitating the trading of unregistered securities. The decision cemented this administration's pro-crypto agenda, reversing an industry crackdown under prior SEC Chair Gary Gensler.

SEC lowers LP accreditation verification bar

March 12, 2025

The SEC's Division of Corporate Finance issued a non-action letter affirming that private funds aren't required to demand documentation from LPs under certain circumstances. VCs marketing funds online previously had to ensure new LPs were accredited investors. LPs afterward could skip the paperwork with a \$200,000 investment.

Uyeda pushes SEC commissioners to "get back to the basics"

March 17, 2025

In a policy-heavy speech, Uyeda declared the SEC had not been doing enough to engage with private fund managers. Public comment periods on rulemaking should be more extensive, he said, advocating for

more transparency in that process. Uyeda began pushing back compliance deadlines for SEC rules made during President Joe Biden's administration.

SEC drops controversial climate disclosures

March 27, 2025

The SEC scuttled its own climate risk disclosure proposal introduced in 2024. The rules were contested by congressional Republicans as well as trade groups. The rescinded measure applied only to public companies, but it would have subjected venture-backed, soon-to-be-public to extensive climate disclosures for the first time.

SEC Chair Paul Atkins sworn in

April 21, 2025

Trump nominee Paul Atkins—previously an SEC commissioner under George W. Bush—said he would oversee a deregulatory push at the commission, including slashing or lowering "compliance burdens" impacting VCs. He outlined plans to make it markedly easier for retail investors to participate in private markets.

Atkins moves to lift retail restrictions on closed-end funds

May 19, 2025

In a significant move, Atkins directed the SEC to reconsider a 23-year-old rule prohibiting closed-end funds from having retail investors if those vehicles invest 15% or more of their assets in private markets. The practice has curtailed access to VC, PE and hedge funds for non-accredited investors. He nevertheless noted that liquidity and fees remain risks for retail investors.

SEC bumps back Form PF deadline (again)

June 11, 2025

The SEC, along with the Commodity Futures Trading Commission, voted to extend a Gensler-era compliance deadline to Oct. 1, 2025, that requires a host of internal disclosures to the SEC about investments, risk and investor protections for VC funds that qualify as registered investment advisers.

Atkins' top securities partner joins SEC

June 13, 2025

The SEC appointed Brian Daly, a partner at Akin Gump Strauss Hauer & Feld as its director of the Division of Investment Management to oversee investments in emerging technologies like AI.

SEC nixes 14 new rules advanced by Gensler

June 16, 2025

The SEC dropped 14 outstanding regulatory proposals on its docket from the Biden administration. These new requirements that would have impacted VCs and startups included heightened cybersecurity disclosures and standards, as well as enhanced ESG-related disclosures.



About [Michael Bodley](#)

Michael Bodley is a senior venture capital reporter at PitchBook News, covering top fund managers and developments affecting limited partners. Based in New York, Michael previously led TheStreet.com's crypto coverage. He also reported for Hedge Fund Alert after breaking into journalism at the San Francisco Chronicle. Originally from Baltimore, Michael graduated from Elon University.

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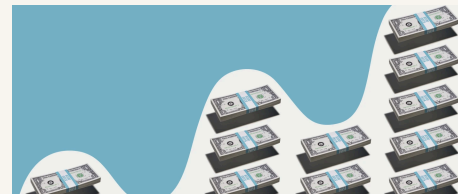


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